While there are state-wise indicators for some social-sector programmes, it is not possible to evaluate the performance of states based just on numbers. The average persondays per household under the MGNREGA in 2011-12 is *the highest* in Andhra Pradesh (58 days) followed by Himachal Pradesh (53 days) and *lowest* in Assam and Punjab (both 26 days) against the ***national average*** of 43 days.

While the share of women's employment under the MGNREGA is the highest in Kerala (92.76 per cent) followed by Tamil Nadu (73.36 per cent), it is the lowest in Uttar Pradesh (16.98 per cent). While the stipulation of one-third women's participation has been maintained at the all India level, in states like Uttar Pradesh, Assam, and Bihar, it has been below the stipulated level.

Progress in terms of 24x7 primary health centres (PHCs), additional PHCs, CHCs and other subdistricts health facilities under the NRHM is the highest in Tamil Nadu and lowest in Himachal Pradesh. Under the Indira Awas Yojana (IAY), Bihar has the highest share followed by Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh, whereas Himachal Pradesh has the lowest.

Conclusive Remarks

(i) Thus, the inter-state comparison of performance of states based on different indicators shows that while some states have performed well in terms of growth indicators, they have performed poorly in terms of other indicators like poverty, rural-urban disparity, unemployment, education, health and financial inclusion. This calls for a rethink on the criteria used for devolution of funds to states under Finance Commissions where criteria like ***'income distance'*** (12th Finance Commission) or ***'fiscal capacity distance'*** (13th Finance Commission) along with population are given high weightage and none of the human development indicators or financial inclusion indicators are used.

(ii) Similarly, the criteria used for awarding 'special category status to states' (hilly and difficult terrain, low population density and/or sizable share of tribal population, strategic location along borders with neighbouring countries, economic and infrastructural